Bridgton Planning Board Meeting Minutes **August 5, 2025**
In Person Meeting **5:00 pm**

Board Members		**Staff Member**	
Deb Brusini, Chair	**X**	Brenda Day, Code Enforcement	
Rolf Madsen, Vice Chair	**X**	Loralee Phillips, Admin Asst., Staff	**X**
Maggie Lynn	**X**	Vacant, Dir. Of Comm Development	
Erika Rowland, Alternate	**X**		
Cathy DiPietro	**X**		
Angie Cook	**X**		
Jessica Warner, Alternate	**X**		

Item #1 **Call to Order**

Item #2 **The Pledge of Allegiance**

Item #3 **Approval of Minutes** **July 1, 2025** **Regular Meeting**
July 15, 2025 **Site Walk**

MOTION Rolf Madsen moved to approve July 1, 2025 minutes, second by Maggie Lynn
MOTION CARRIES 5/0

MOTION Rolf Madsen moved to approve July 15, 2025 minutes, second by Maggie Lynn
MOTION CARRIES 5/0

Item #4 **Old Business**

4a. **Public Hearing on Ministerial Amendments to the Land Use Code**

Chair Brusini opened the Public Hearing. She gave an overview of the proposed changes.

MOTION Angie Cook moved to recommend that these changes be placed on the agenda for the selectboard for the November Warrant, Cathy DiPietro
MOTION CARRIES 5/0

Libby Graffam of 25 Holden Hills asked questions about licensing and commercial businesses in residential neighborhoods. Chair Brusini referred Ms. Graffam to Code Enforcement Officer, Brenda Day, for clarification.

4b. **R&SVP Event Barn**
Hio Ridge Rd
Map 8 Lot 8
Findings of Fact and Conclusions of Law

Chair Brusini noted brief changes as noted in Findings of Fact and Conclusions of Law.

MOTION Rolf Madsen moved to approve Findings of Fact and Conclusions of Law for R&SVP Event Barn with changes as noted, second by Cathy DiPietro
MOTION CARRIES 5/0

Item #5 New Business

5a. Ingall Hill Estates
Sam Ingalls Rd
Map 17 Lot 23-1
Subdivision Amendment

The Board deemed the application complete.

Bill Gerrish or Sebago Technics, representing Nicholas Gagnon, owner of 245 Sam Ingalls Road, gave an overview of the proposed amendment.

Chair Brusini asked Mr. Gerrish to supply the original subdivision plan to the Board for review regarding the stream.

MOTION Rolf Madsen moved to tentatively approve the Ingall Hill Estates subdivision amendment with condition that applicants supply original subdivision plan, pending approval of Findings of Fact and Conclusions of Law, second by Angie Cook
MOTION CARRIES 5/0

Item #6 Old Business (Continued)

6a. Bridgton Food Pantry
Main St
Map 25 Lot 4
Public Hearing

Reed Holden, representing the Board of the Bridgton Food Pantry stated that the property was purchased in 2023 and since then, they have been working on fundraising and this application. He also stated that there has been over $26000 raised above the anticipated cost of the building.

Tom Greer of Dalfanso Engineering gave an overview of changes made since the last meeting. He stated that the test pits came back, and the soil is excellent for building. Mr. Greer also stated that Mark Hampton completed test pits, remapped the wetlands and provided a wetlands report. Also, Stormwater Management has been redone.

Mr. Greer continued to say that buffering has changed slightly on the Cross Street side and that there is a small row of maple trees that will be saved for natural buffers, with pine trees behind it for density. He also noted that the invasive knotweed has been removed from the site.

Abutters were given an opportunity to ask questions and make comments regarding the proposal.

Nicole Toomey of 2 Plummers Landing asked about the natural boundaries, wetland impacts on her property, and traffic flow.

Jennifer Preece of Sweden, but soon to be 494 Main St, Bridgton, asked about delivery scheduling and impact on her property during construction.

Libby Graffam seconded Ms. Priests concerns regarding delivery scheduling and stated that the residents in the area should be considered.

Brandon Toomey of 2 Plummers Landing commented that the large pine tree is one of the largest in the State of Maine. Mr. Toomey also commented on wetland concerns, uses in town districts, and limiting the use of the food pantry to Bridgton residents only.

Penny Robbins, 260 Pond Road, stated that Good Shepherd does not dictate hours of operation.

Chair Brusini and Rolf Madsen asked that a copy of the contract from the Good Shepherd be supplied to the Board to ensure it does not exceed any of the standards.

Debbie Ogle of Kezar Heights voiced concerned regarding people from different communities being fed partially by a block grant that is meant for Bridgton residents.

Tracy Martin, executive director for the Lakes Region Recovery Center in Bridgton, stated that it is our job, as a community, to make sure that people don't go hungry. She also stated that the unhoused are already within the community, living in cars, unable to pay rent and/or childcare and the food pantry ensure that they do not go hungry.

Libby Graffam stated to Ms. Martin that it needs to be considered that this is a residential area and if it was constructed in her neighborhood that she might feel differently.

Dave Akins of Lower Main Street stated that he thinks the scale of the project is too large for a town the size of Bridgton. He stated that he agrees that there is a need, but that this is not the right fit for location.

Maureen Johnson of Pond Road stated that she has been a volunteer at the Harrison Food Pantry and that in comparison, Bridgton Food Pantry is exceptional. She stated that these volunteers are here to help and not many people do that.

Sarah Reed of 121 Wildwood Road stated that there are a lot of stigmas in the room around those who utilize the food pantry, but they are mothers and children in need and as a community, we should help one another.

Amy Oulette, volunteer for the Bridgton Food Pantry, stated that this is a food pantry, not a homeless shelter. The volunteers will not be soliciting for people to stay in the pantry or housing them.

Leslie McAllister of 58 Sunnybrook Farm Rd stated that the Planning Board is going to base a decision on facts and ordinances. Ms. McAllister also stated that the Bridgton Food Pantry does an excellent job of catering to specific needs of its clients with health restrictions.

Norman Oulette, volunteer for the Bridgton Food Pantry, stated that he and his wife have volunteered for 2 years at the pantry. He stated that there is fun and laughter in a time where most are discouraged.

Debbie Sullivan of North Road and volunteer at the Bridgton Food Pantry stated that she volunteers for about 20 hours per week to the food pantry. She emphasized the importance of the food pantry to the community, specifically to mothers and children.

Chris Green of Naples and volunteers at the Bridgton Food Pantry stated that the traffic is limited and this is essential to the community.

Tom Greer stated that the volunteers have and continue to put in an extreme amount of time and effort into running the pantry and supporting it and that the Planning Board should have enough information at this time to decide.

Ella Nevill of 4 Oak Street stated that she supports the food pantry's mission, but not the location and impact on the neighborhood. Ms. Nevill also brought up concerns about signage, consideration for the neighborhood, and zoning for businesses versus residential.

Reed Holden answered questions and addressed concerns from the public. He stated that they searched for a location to rent and were not able to secure a space. Mr. Holden also stated that there is a dumpster pad on the site plan, but there will not be a dumpster there, but it may be used for a bottle depository in the future, but all food waste is taken off site and used for compost.

The Board began reviewing and had an opportunity to ask clarifying questions to the applicant.

Chair Brusini stated that the proposed project is classified as Institutional Use in the Downtown Village Neighborhood, which was also the determination of the Code Enforcement Officer.

Rolf Madsen asked how the semi delivery trucks will deliver on a posted road in the Winter. Mr. Greer stated that they will utilize the Lower Main Street entrance as that road is not posted. Discussion ensued regarding David Madsen, Public Works Directors Impact Statement. It was determined that further clarification is needed by Mr. Madsen on whether Lower Main Street is a posted road.

Chair Brusini asked Mr. Greer to explain how this proposal is consistent with the towns Comprehensive Plan. She asked for a written narrative to be submitted.

Discussion ensued between the Board and Mr. Greer with questions regarding tree removal, surface water drainage, lighting, parking, and noise from refrigeration units.

MOTION Rolf Madsen moved to recess Public Hearing to be continued on August 19, 2025, at 5PM with information supplied to staff by August 12, 2025, second by Angie Cook
MOTION CARRIES 5/0

Item #7 Public Comment

Item #8 Other

Item #9 Adjourn

MOTION Angie Cook moved to adjourn, second by Rolf Madsen
MOTION CARRIES 5/0